

Freemium V1.0 — Design Spec

Consolidated design decisions for the V1.0 freemium model, locked through a working session between Daniel (founder) and Claude on 2026-05-21-22.

This doc supersedes scattered conversation notes. If implementation diverges, update this doc first.

Executive summary

StitchPad's freemium V1.0 is structured around three deliberate phases:

- 1. **First Month (days 1–30)** — Unlimited customers, 30 AI drafts to try. AI is gated from day 1 (real cost); customers are not.
- 2. **Free post-First-Month (day 31+)** — 15 customers active, the rest locked but visible. 5 AI drafts/month.
- 3. **Pro / Atelier** — Unlimited customers, generous AI quotas.

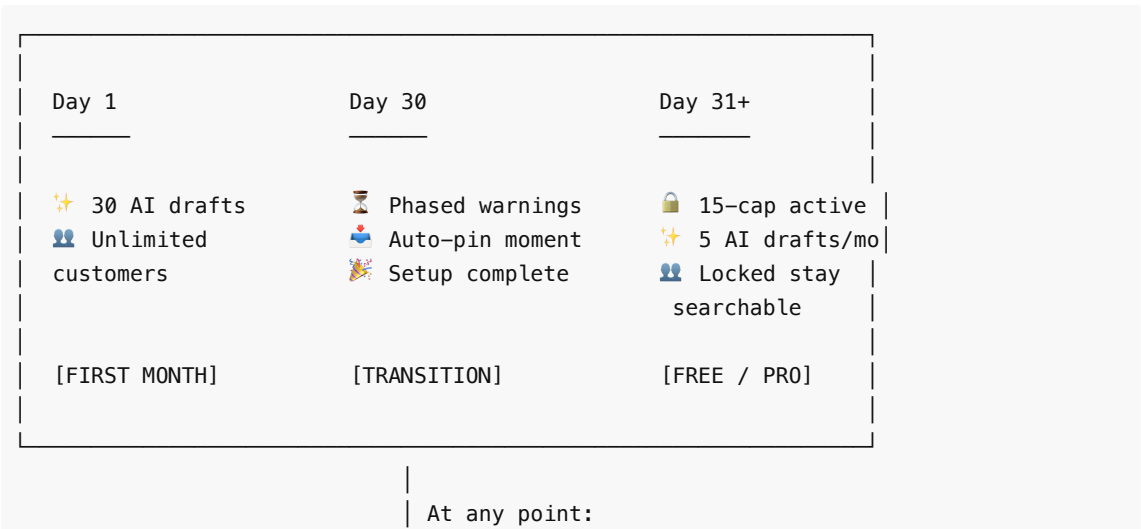
The transition at day 30 is engineered to be **respectful, predictable, and conversion-aware** — not a punishment. Eight design decisions across UX, copy, mechanics, and architecture collectively turn what could be a "bait and switch" moment into a designed product experience.

The four marketing value props

These four lines together describe the entire freemium model in honest, respectful language:

Line	Source decision
"Your first 30 days, no limits."	#5 — First Month
"We never delete your customers."	#2 — Lock framing
"Your data never changes overnight."	#4 — Lazy reconcile
"Your data is yours — export anytime, free."	#8 — Trust at transition

The model in one diagram



▼

Upgrade to Pro
Unlimited customers
500 AI drafts/month
¥2,000/mo

Decision #1 — Smart Auto-Pinning ("Your Top 15")

Problem solved

Forcing tailors to manually choose 15 customers out of 50+ at the end of First Month is cognitively brutal. They'd abandon rather than choose.

Locked rules

Auto-pin algorithm:

1. Sort all customers by **last activity** (most recent order/contact/edit), descending.
2. Take top **9** → "Active by usage" bucket.
3. From remaining customers, sort by **created date**, descending.
4. Take top **6** → "Recently added" bucket.
5. Everything else → locked.

Pseudo-code:

```
sortedByActivity = customers.sortedByDescending { it.lastActivityAt }
activeBucket = sortedByActivity.take(9)
remaining = customers - activeBucket
sortedByCreated = remaining.sortedByDescending { it.createdAt }
recentAddBucket = sortedByCreated.take(6)
active = activeBucket + recentAddBucket
locked = customers - active
```

A customer who's both recently active AND recently added naturally lands in the activity bucket — no double-counting.

Open-order edge case

A customer with an open order from 35+ days ago who isn't among the top 9 by recency will be auto-locked. The tailor would still see the order in their pipeline but couldn't open the customer detail without unlocking or swapping. **We accept this edge case** as rare enough not to warrant special logic.

Visual — auto-pin transition screen

← Welcome to Month 2
🎉 You added 47 customers in your first month — that's strong growth.



Badges

- Active-bucket customers: [Active · Nd] (last activity)
- Recent-add bucket: [Just added · Nd] (created date)
- These badges appear next to each customer on the transition screen so the auto-pin feels deliberate, not arbitrary.

Override

A "Review and adjust" CTA lets the tailor manually swap any auto-pinned customer for any locked one before committing.

Decision #2 — "Locked" terminology with visible read-only access

Problem solved

Tailors panic at "locked" customers, assuming data is lost. The word "locked" survives — but the model around it is rewritten to make the anxiety baseless.

The core rule

"Locked" applies only to NEW WORK — not to viewing data. A locked customer is fully visible, fully searchable, fully read-only-explorable. The lock only gates new orders, new measurements, and profile edits.

Locked rules

Touchpoint	Behavior
Customer list	Two-section layout: Active (15) on top, Locked (32) expandable section below
Search bar	Searches across both active + locked. Locked results show a badge

Tap a locked customer	Full detail screen, read-only, with  banner + two unlock paths
Measurements / order history	Fully viewable read-only
New order picker	Locked customers appear dimmed with "Swap to use →" CTA
Terminology	"Locked" everywhere (not "archived", "inactive", "paused"). Verb pair: lock / unlock

Two unlock paths

Every locked customer detail offers both:

- **Upgrade to Pro** — unlocks all locked customers
- **Swap into active** — picks a current active customer to lock in their place

Visual — locked customer detail

← Tunde Bakare

 Locked – read-only

All data preserved. To take new orders or measurements, swap or upgrade.

 +234 801 234 5670

 5 Marina, Lagos Island

— Measurements —

Taken 4 months ago

Bust 36 · Waist 28 · Hip 38

[View all measurements]

— Order history —

3 orders · ₦58,000 total

— Unlock to start a new order —

[ Upgrade to Pro – unlocks all]

[ Swap into your active 15]

Copy library — supporting language that drains negative valence

Surface	String
Customer list section header	 Locked · 32 customers
Section subtitle	Safe and searchable. Unlock anytime to take new orders.
Locked detail banner	 Locked — read-only. All data preserved.

Empty locked state	No locked customers — you're all caught up.
Unlock CTA (primary)	Unlock to start a new order
Settings marketing copy	"We never delete your customers."

Decision #3 — AI-focused conversion engine

Problem solved

Under the unlimited-customers First Month, customer count is dead as a conversion signal. AI usage replaces it as the primary daily lever.

The signal hierarchy

Period	Primary conversion signal	Secondary
First Month (days 1–30)	AI usage (drafts used / quota / time saved)	Customer count (compact, no fraction)
Day 28–30 (transition)	AI usage + customer-count framing kicks in	Both compounding
Post-First-Month (day 31+)	Whichever ratio is higher (AI or customer cap)	The other

Value translation everywhere

The single highest-leverage addition: surface a **time-saved estimate** at every AI touchpoint.

```
minutes_saved = drafts_used × 1.5
```

No new tracking required — purely computed from existing usage count. Converts every screen from "you used X" to "you saved Y minutes".

Milestone interrupts (positive, dismissible)

Fire a brief positive interrupt at 5th, 10th, 20th, 25th draft. Soft upgrade nudge framed as celebration, not pressure.

Visuals

PlanCard during First Month — AI is the headline:

[FIRST MONTH · 23 days left]

🌟 AI drafts

5 of 30 used

~7 minutes saved drafting messages

👥 12 customers added · no limits this month

[How First Month works →]

10th draft milestone — positive interrupt:

🌟 Nice — that's your 10th AI draft

You've saved about 15 minutes drafting this month. Pro gives you 500 drafts/mo and never resets.

[See Pro features] [Keep drafting]

AI quota exhausted — success-framed:

[FIRST MONTH · AI USED UP] 🎉

You used all 30 AI drafts this month — ~45 minutes saved on messages.

Pro tailors get 500/month. Never run out.

[Upgrade now] AI resets June 1

Deferred to V1.5+

- AI-attributed revenue ("your AI drafts contributed to ₦47k in orders")
- Streak tracker ("you've used AI 6 days in a row")
- Real cohort percentiles ("top 20% of AI users")
- Multi-feature Smart Grow (post-caption, referral message, etc.)

Decision #4 — Lazy reconcile with skeleton-loaded UX moment

Problem solved

At month-end transitions, server reconcile load could theoretically cluster. The existing architecture is already lazy (foreground-triggered, not cron-driven). What's needed is making the lazy reconcile a **deliberate UX moment**, not invisible plumbing.

Locked rules

Gap	Fix
No dedup — reconcile retries on every state change	Add <code>lastReconciledAt</code> on user doc; server returns early if last reconcile was within Xh and welcome state hasn't flipped
Silent failures	Surface reconcile failures via Snackbar + log; track success rate via Cloud Functions metrics

No UX connection	First-post-First-Month reconcile triggers the auto-pin transition screen (#1) via skeleton-loaded transition
Timeout protection at 200-customer scale	Raise cloud function timeout to 120s as safety margin
App.kt LaunchedEffect is fragile	Refactor into a root ViewModel that owns the reconcile lifecycle

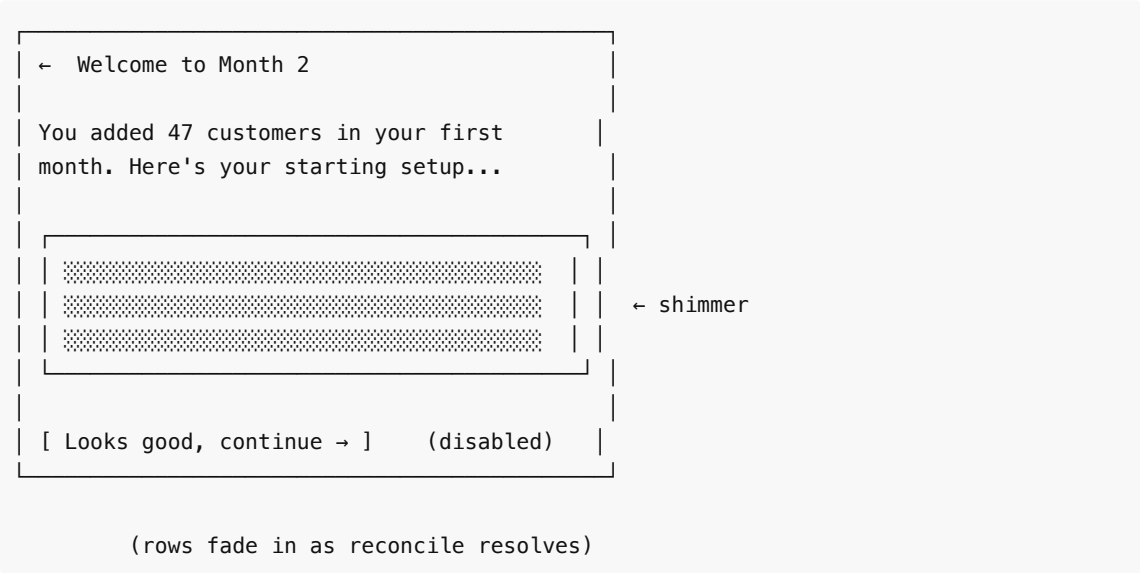
Visual — skeleton loading instead of "we're organizing" screen

Wrong pattern (don't do):

```
"We're organizing your 47 customers"
```

This frames the system as the actor mutating user data — contradicts the "we never change your data overnight" value prop.

Right pattern (do): Show the auto-pin screen **skeleton** immediately. Header + structure render at once; rows shimmer-load as reconcile resolves. User feels in control the entire time.



Cost characteristics

- Per-user reconcile: ~50ms compute, ~200 reads, ~32 writes
- Cohort of 1,000 users: ~\$0.10 per First-Month flip
- Cohort of 10,000 users: ~\$1.00 per First-Month flip
- **At V1.0 launch scale, the cost concern is hypothetical.**

Marketing line earned

```
"Your data never changes overnight."
```

Earned by making the transition a foreground moment, not background mutation.

Decision #5 — "First Month" framing (not "Setup Month", not "Welcome Month")

Problem solved

The previous "Welcome Window" copy doesn't translate from 30 customers to unlimited. "Setup Month" implies users are still configuring their account. **"First Month"** is plain, professional, and accurate.

Locked rules

Surface	Wording
User-facing name	First Month
System badge	[FIRST MONTH · N days left]
Marketing headline	Your first 30 days, no limits.
Internal data fields	Unchanged (welcomeBonusAppliedAt, WELCOME_CUSTOMER_CAP, etc.)
Customer cap (technical)	200 (system safety ceiling)
Customer cap (user-facing)	"Unlimited" — never expose 200 in normal UI

Post-signup splash — sets all three expectations upfront

Your first 30 days, no limits

 Bring your business in
Add unlimited customers,
measurements, and orders
this month

 Try AI on us
30 free AI drafts to save
time on customer messages

 After 30 days
Your 15 most active customers
stay handy. The rest stay
safe and searchable.

[Let's go →]

Phased dashboard banners

Days 1–15 (early — encourage):

[FIRST MONTH · 23 days left]

Add as many customers as you need –
no limits for 23 more days.

12 customers added · 5 of 30 AI drafts used

Days 16–25 (mid — plant the upgrade idea):

[FIRST MONTH · 8 days left]

Strong start – 28 customers added.

After day 30, your 15 most active
customers stay handy. Want to keep all
of them?

[See Pro features]

Days 26–30 (ending — clear next step):

[FIRST MONTH ENDS IN 3 DAYS] ⌚

Impressive – 47 customers in your first
month.

On Friday, your 15 most active customers
stay handy. The other 32 stay safe – just
unlock or swap to take new orders.

[Keep all 47 – Upgrade]

[See what'll stay active]

Edge case — 200-customer power user

If a tailor hits the technical 200 ceiling during First Month, treat them as a **white-glove escalation**, not a wall.



You're moving fast!

You've added 200 customers in your
first month – that's exceptional
growth.

Send us a WhatsApp and we'll help you with this volume directly.

[🗨️ WhatsApp support]

[Or upgrade to Pro now]

Turn the cap into an upsell moment for the highest-conversion-intent user segment.

Decision #6 — Repurpose PlanCard state machine for AI usage

Problem solved

PlanCard's three-state machine (inline/warn/locked) is wasted if it only fires on customer count. Same code paths, different inputs depending on period.

State machine rule

```
during First Month (days 1–30):  
  drive states from AI usage only  
  customer count is hidden (no fraction shown, "unlimited" framing)  
  
post-First-Month (day 31+):  
  drive states from MAX(ai_ratio, customer_ratio)  
  show the signal with the higher ratio  
  tiebreaker: AI wins (higher-priority conversion lever)  
  
priority:  
  if either signal ≥ 100% → Locked state  
  elif either signal ≥ 80% → Warn state  
  else → Inline (both signals visible compactly)
```

Visuals

First Month · Inline (AI 0–79%):

[FIRST MONTH · 23 days left]
🌟 AI: 5 of 30 used
👥 12 customers added · no limits

First Month · Warn (AI 80–99%):

[FIRST MONTH · AI ALMOST OUT] ⚠️

4 AI drafts left this month.
Pro gives you 500 drafts/month.

[Upgrade — ¥2,000/mo]

First Month · Locked (AI = 100%):

[FIRST MONTH · AI USED UP] 🎉

You used all 30 drafts — ~45 min saved.
Pro tailors get 500/month.

[Upgrade now] Resets June 1

Post-First-Month · Inline (both < 80%):

[FREE]

👤 9 of 15 customers

🌟 2 of 5 AI drafts used

[Upgrade] >

Post-First-Month · Locked (customers at 15):

[FREE · LIMIT REACHED] 🔒

You've hit your 15-customer limit.
Upgrade for unlimited customers, or swap
with a locked customer.

[Upgrade now] [See locked customers]

Engineering cost

~100 lines of Compose. Reuses existing PlanCard state-machine plumbing. Only adds a second input pair (aiDraftsUsed , aiDraftLimit) and a flag (isFirstMonth).

Decision #7 — Referral lever for long-tail Free users (V1.1)

Problem solved

Long-tail Free users (8/15 customers, low AI use) have no upgrade pressure. Turn them into acquisition channels instead.

Validation criteria

A referral counts only when **all** are true:

1. New tailor downloads via the referrer's link
2. Completes signup (account verified)

3. Creates **5 customers** in their own account

Reward structure

Customer slots — **STACKS, no cap:**

Valid referrals	Slots earned	Cap (15 + bonus)
1	+2	17
3	+6	21
5	+10	25
10	+20	35
20	+40	55

Each unlock fires when the referred tailor adds their 5th customer.

Pro time — **DISCRETE 1-month grants at every 5 paying referrals:**

Paying referrals reached	Reward granted at that moment
5	+1 month Pro
10	+1 more month Pro
15	+1 more month Pro
20	+1 more month Pro

Each grant extends `proExpiresAt` by 30 days. **No cumulative counter shown** — UI always reads "next reward at N more paying referrals", never "X months total earned".

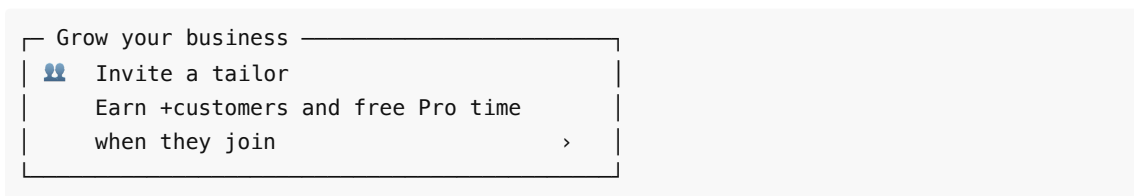
"Paying" definition: referred tailor has paid for at least 1 month of Pro. Lifetime credit (doesn't unvoke if they later cancel). 14-day chargeback window must pass before counting.

Privacy rule

No individual referral identities displayed anywhere. Aggregate counters only. Notifications use generic phrasing ("a tailor you invited").

Visuals

Settings entry point:



Invite screen:

← Invite a tailor

Help a fellow tailor get started – earn rewards every time they join and use it.

Your invite link

stitchpad.app/i/aF3kQ

[ Copy] [ Share via WhatsApp]

— Customer slots (stacks +2 each) —

✓ 2 valid referrals +4 customers
Each referral = +2 more

— Pro time (1 free month per 5 paying) —

Progress: 1 of 5 paying referrals



4 more paying referrals → 1 free month

— Activity —

5 tailors signed up
2 reached 5+ customers
1 upgraded to Pro

Slot reward notification (no names):



A tailor you invited just hit 5 customers!

You've earned +2 customer slots – your cap is now 17 customers.

[Invite more tailors]

Pro reward notification:



Your 5th invited tailor upgraded to Pro!

You've earned 1 free month of Pro – starting today.

Refer 5 more paying tailors to earn another free month.

[Explore Pro features]

WhatsApp share template (pre-filled)

Hey [name] 🙌

I've been using StitchPad – it's a clean app for managing customers, measurements, and orders. First 30 days are unlimited.

Use my link so we both get started:
stitchpad.app/i/aF3kQ

Anti-abuse rules

Risk	Mitigation
Self-referral	Validate referrer ≠ new user (different phone + device fingerprint)
Fake customer adds	Customers must have name + phone + at least one of (email / address / measurement)
Refund/chargeback	14-day refund delay before Pro counts

Business economics

- 5 paying referrals × ₦2,000/mo = ₦10,000 MRR for company
- Cost = 1 month Pro reward ≈ ₦2,000 one-time
- **5× ROI per milestone, indefinitely sustainable**

Ship timing: V1.1

Decision #8 — Trust at the transition (no fake social proof)

Problem solved

Mishandled transition could become public complaints on WhatsApp/Twitter. Address with trust-building tactics, not fabricated social-proof claims.

V1.0 ships (genuine, no data dependency)

Tactic	Surface
Founder voice	One-time screen during transition flow
Visible WhatsApp support bar	Persistent during transition + first 7 days post
CSV data export	Settings → "Export all my data" (Free for all plans)

No-surprise communication	Already locked in #5 (phased banners)
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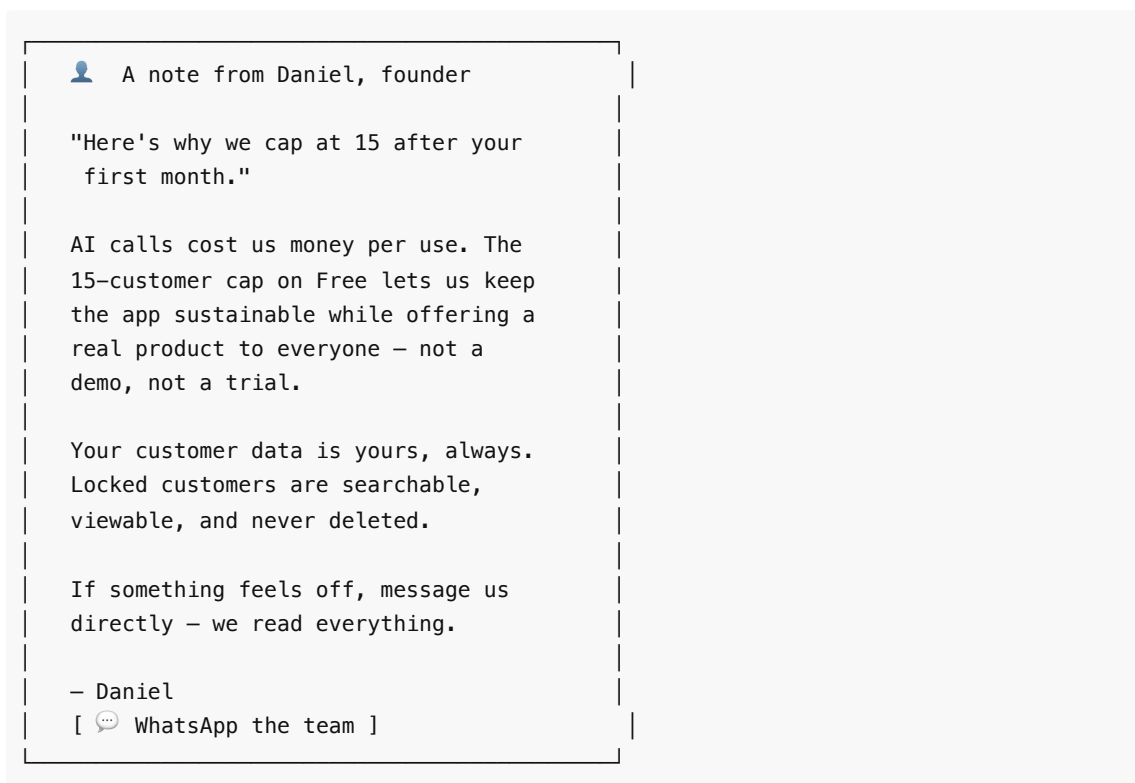
V1.1+ ships (requires real data)

Tactic	When
Opt-in testimonials with real names	V1.1+ once collected
Aggregate cohort stats	V1.2+ once data exists

No fabricated stats anywhere, ever.

Visual — founder voice screen

Appears once during the transition flow, dismissible:



Visual — persistent WhatsApp support bar

Visible during transition + first 7 days after:



Visual — data export in Settings

Your data

 Export all my data
Download your customers, orders,
and measurements as CSV. Free for
all plans.

Testimonial collection plan (V1.1+)

1. **Trigger:** Pro tailor for 30+ days with engagement signals
2. **Ask in-app:** opt-in form for name, location, 1-2 line quote
3. **Approval:** Daniel/PM reviews before publishing
4. **Display:** rotating slots on transition screen, Settings, marketing site

V1.0 builds the schema (`testimonial: Testimonial?` on user doc or a separate `testimonials` collection) but ships nothing visible.

Marketing copy library

Centralized so engineering pulls from one source.

Headlines

Surface	String
Post-signup splash	Your first 30 days, no limits
Welcome ending splash	Welcome to Month 2
AI exhausted	First Month · AI USED UP
Customer cap reached (post-First-Month)	Free · Limit reached

Value props (use in marketing site, App Store, Play Store, share copy)

1. Your first 30 days, no limits.
2. We never delete your customers.
3. Your data never changes overnight.
4. Your data is yours — export anytime, free.

System badges

Period	Badge
Days 1–25 of First Month	[FIRST MONTH · N days left]
Days 26–30 of First Month	[FIRST MONTH ENDS IN N DAYS] ⌚
Post-First-Month, AI warn	[FREE · AI ALMOST OUT] ⚠
Post-First-Month, customer warn	[FREE · ALMOST FULL] ⚠
Post-First-Month, AI locked	[FREE · AI USED UP] 🚫
Post-First-Month, customer locked	[FREE · LIMIT REACHED] 🔒

Pro tier (during reward)	[PRO · 1 FREE MONTH FROM REFERRALS] ★
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Plural grammar warning

%1\$d customers left before your free limit — at N=1, reads "1 customers" (wrong). **Use a plural string resource** before V1.0 ship.

V1.0 vs V1.1+ scope split

V1.0 ships

- ✔ #1 Smart auto-pinning (9 by activity + 6 by created)
- ✔ #2 Locked terminology with read-only access
- ✔ #3 AI-focused conversion engine (time-saved, milestone interrupts, exhaustion celebration)
- ✔ #4 Lazy reconcile with skeleton-loaded transition screen
- ✔ #5 "First Month" framing + post-signup splash + phased banners + 200 cap with white-glove escalation
- ✔ #6 PlanCard state machine driven by max(AI ratio, customer ratio)
- ✔ #8 Founder voice + WhatsApp support bar + CSV export (no fake testimonials)

V1.1 ships

- ✔ #7 Referral mechanic (full implementation)
- ✔ #8 Opt-in real testimonials (populating empty slots from V1.0)

V1.2+ ships

- Aggregate cohort stats (once data exists)
 - AI-attributed revenue
 - Streak tracker
 - Multi-feature Smart Grow surfaces
-

V1.0 engineering prep checklist

These changes must land in V1.0 even though the features ship later — without them, V1.1 doubles in cost.

User doc schema additions

Field	Type	Purpose	Ships in
referralCode	String	Generated at signup	V1.0 (V1.1 uses)
referredByCode	String?	Tracks who invited	V1.0 (V1.1 uses)
earnedBonusCustomerCap	Int (default 0)	Tracks +slots from referrals	V1.0 (V1.1 uses)
validReferralCount	Int (default 0)	Count of fully-validated referrals	V1.0 (V1.1 uses)

payingReferralCount	Int (default 0)	Count of referrals who paid Pro	V1.0 (V1.1 uses)
proExpiresAt	Timestamp?	When Pro window ends (real or earned)	V1.0 (V1.1 uses)
lastReconciledAt	Timestamp?	Dedup for reconcile	V1.0
testimonial	Object?	Opt-in testimonial	V1.0 (V1.1 uses)

Code changes (V1.0)

Change	File(s)
Bump WELCOME_CUSTOMER_CAP: 30 → 200	EntitlementsCalculator.kt
Rename "Welcome Month" → "First Month" in all UI strings	strings.xml
Replace plan_card_subtitle_inline with new copy	strings.xml
Fix plural grammar bug (%1\$d customers left)	strings.xml (use plural resource)
Customer cap calculation = baseCap + earnedBonusCustomerCap	EntitlementsCalculator.kt
PlanCard accepts AI usage inputs + isFirstMonth flag	PlanCard.kt
CustomerSlotState enum review (use LOCKED, not ARCHIVED)	enum file
Locked customer detail page (read-only)	new screen + nav
Customer list two-section layout (Active + Locked)	customer list refactor
Search includes locked customers + badge	search refactor
Auto-pin transition screen with skeleton loading	new screen
Founder voice screen (one-time, dismissible)	new screen
WhatsApp support bar component	new shared component
CSV data export from Settings	new feature
White-glove escalation at 200 cap	edge-case screen
Move reconcile trigger from App.kt LaunchedEffect to root ViewModel	refactor
Surface reconcile failures via Snackbar	error handling
Add lastReconciledAt server-side dedup	cloud function update
Raise cloud function timeout to 120s	firebase.json or function decorator

Server / cloud function changes (V1.0)

Change	Purpose
Add lastReconciledAt write in reconcileCustomerSlots	Dedup support
Early return if recently reconciled + welcome state unchanged	Cost control
Update auto-pin algorithm (9 by activity + 6 by created)	Match locked spec
Increase function timeout to 120s	Safety margin at 200-customer scale
Add structured logs for reconcile metrics	Observability

Open items / non-decisions

These were discussed but not locked. Revisit before V1.0 ship:

1. **Cap on referral slot stacking** — currently unlimited; do we want to cap at, say, +50 to prevent pathological cases? Open.
2. **Testimonial schema** — single object on user doc OR separate `testimonials` collection? Open. Probably separate collection for moderation.
3. **Plural grammar** — Compose Multiplatform doesn't have plural string resources the same way Android XML does. Engineering needs to settle on a pattern. Open.
4. **CSV export format** — what fields? Customer details only, or include order/measurement history? Probably full export for completeness. Open.
5. **Founder voice screen frequency** — one-time only, or re-appear at certain trigger points? Probably one-time, but flag for analytics.
6. **AI minute-saved estimate** — locked at 1.5 min/draft. Worth instrumenting in V1.1 to refine. Out of scope for V1.0.

Glossary

Term	Meaning
First Month	The 30-day calendar-month period after signup. Internal field: <code>welcomeBonusAppliedAt</code> .
Locked customer	A customer in the read-only state (not deleted, not hidden).
Active 15	The 15 most-recent/active customers a Free user keeps post-First-Month.
Auto-pin	The deterministic algorithm that picks which customers stay active.
Bonus coins	Welcome AI drafts. 30 at signup, consumed before monthly free quota.
Setup Month	Rejected naming. Use "First Month" instead.
Archive	Rejected naming. Use "Locked" instead.
Valid referral	Referred tailor: link signup + 5 customers added.
Paying referral	Valid referral who has paid for at least 1 month of Pro (14-day chargeback window passed).

Decisions log

Date	Decision	Locked by
2026-05-21	Option C (200-cap First Month + 15-cap post + AI gated day 1)	Daniel + PM
2026-05-21	"First Month" terminology (vs "Setup Month")	Daniel
2026-05-21	"Unlimited" public framing (200 is internal safety cap)	Daniel
2026-05-21	Auto-pin 9 by activity + 6 by created	Daniel
2026-05-21	"Locked" terminology kept (not "archived")	Daniel
2026-05-22	Referral: +2 slots stacking, 1 month Pro per 5 paying refs (discrete)	Daniel
2026-05-22	No individual referral names displayed	Daniel
2026-05-22	No fabricated testimonials at V1.0	Daniel